Meanwhile, there was another sort of nonfiction book in the air. Walker was pleased with the way we had worked together on the biochemistry text, and since he had hooked me into doing a course for student nurses, he suggested that we do a chemistry text for student nurses together.

I was not anxious to do this, for I was not pleased with the way we had worked together on the text, and I had many other books to do, which Walker had not. Nevertheless, I did not like to turn him down flatly.

I compromised by agreeing, without undue enthusiasm, and then leaving it entirely up to Walker to find a publisher. If he failed as I thought he might, I would be off the hook.

As I suspected, Williams & Wilkins turned down the proposal, but Walker then got in touch with McGraw-Hill. On June 25, McGraw-Hill wrote to ask for an outline, and I noted in my diary, rather callously, "Well, that's Walker's worry." I did not intend to move a finger to get the project off the ground.

8

My science fiction continued to go well. I had a contract for a third Lucky Starr book, and something new had come up.

1 1 followed instructions very carefully in this book, with the result I didn't like it very well when it was completed. It was the only book in which I accepted supervision of this kind. Afterward, I put the lecture out of my mind and just let the words flow naturally. Things went much better that way.

Twayne Press had the idea of producing what they called "Twayne Triplets." The plan was to have someone knowledgeable in science invent a planet with a particular astronomical or chemical situation, after which three different authors would write three different stories all based on that planet as background.

One of the backgrounds involved two stars and a planet at the apices of an equilateral triangle—which would be a stable 'Trojan situation." There would then be a planet with two suns, each a different color, plus a few other items of interest. I could carry it from there, and two other authors, Poul Anderson and, I believe, Virginia Blish, were to do the other two stories of the Triplet. When all three were done we would have a book out of it.

I thought about it and found a flaw. I knew that I could write to order, but what about Poul and Virginia? What if they couldn't get around to it? What if